Return Visits App

A plain-language guide for everyday use

> **Recommended for regular phone use:** add Return Visits to your Home Screen and use that copy consistently. It opens like an app, but its contacts are still stored locally on this device. The browser version and Home Screen app may keep separate data and do not automatically sync; adding the icon does not transfer contacts already saved in your browser. The first time you open the app in a browser, a short tip at the top of the Contacts page explains how to add it to your Home Screen and asks you to open Settings (⚙) and set your default information before adding contacts. Choose **Got it** and the app opens Settings → Defaults for you; after you save, it tells you that you may now add contacts and offers a 👥 link back to the Contacts page. The install steps never appear inside the installed app. If you already entered contacts in a browser, either continue using that browser or export an encrypted backup and restore it in the Home Screen app before switching. See backup instructions.

- **iPhone or iPad:** For the best Home Screen app experience, open this page in Safari. If the link opened inside another app, use its menu or Share options to choose **Open in Safari**. In Safari, tap **Share** → **Add to Home Screen**, then open Return Visits from its new icon.
- **Android:** Open this page in Chrome, open the browser menu, and choose **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**. Menu wording may vary by device.

A website cannot force links to open in Safari or install itself. Complete these steps before entering contacts when possible. The browser copy and Home Screen app may have separate local data; back up before switching if you already have contacts.

What this app does

Return Visits is free to use, with no app fees or subscription. It is intentionally a simple tool for maintaining contact details and tracking return visits, not a full-featured contact-management app. It may have fewer features or be less reliable than paid products. The app is provided as-is. Your internet or mobile provider may charge for data, and third-party services have their own terms.

The app helps you organize contact details and visit notes, find contacts by name or location, view contacts on a map, and print contact information.

Important: your information stays on this device

Contacts and settings are stored in the browser on the device where you use the app. They do not automatically sync to your other devices or browsers. You can optionally turn on a backup to your own Dropbox; see Cloud backup (optional).

> Before changing devices or browsers, clearing browser data, or removing and reinstalling the app, make an encrypted backup. Local records may become unavailable after these changes. To use your contacts again, restore the backup on the device where you reinstall or open the app. Step-by-step instructions are in Protect your information and make a backup.

> If you have contacts in more than one browser or app copy, choose one copy to keep before deleting anything. Full backups replace the destination data; they do not merge copies. To combine several collections, use one copy as the base and import individual contacts from the other copies. Verify the combined records, then make a fresh backup before clearing unused copies. See Consolidate copies and remove unused data.

Passphrase (optional)

- A passphrase is not required. By default the app opens right away and stores your contacts on this device without encryption.
- To protect your data, open **Settings** → **Passphrase** → **Turn On Passphrase**, enter and confirm a passphrase with at least 12 characters, and choose **Save Passphrase**. Your saved data is then encrypted, and you will enter the passphrase each time you open the app on that device and browser. The app then shows you a **recovery code**; see Recovery code below.
- If you turn a passphrase on, keep it and your recovery code somewhere safe. If you lose both, the app cannot unlock that device's encrypted contacts.
- A passphrase does not sync or restore contacts by itself. To recover your contacts after reinstalling the app or to move them to another device, you need a backup. See Protect your information and make a backup.

Change your passphrase

If a passphrase is on, after unlocking this copy of the app, open **Settings** → **Passphrase**. The section says you may change the passphrase or turn it off. Choose **Change Passphrase**, enter your current passphrase, then enter and confirm a new passphrase of at least 12 characters. The app re-encrypts this copy's saved contacts and settings with the new passphrase. This does not change other browser or Home Screen copies, or the passphrase on backup files you already exported. Keep using the old passphrase for those existing backups; a new backup will use the new passphrase.

To stop using a passphrase, open **Settings** → **Passphrase** and choose **Turn Off Passphrase**. The app first explains what this means: your data is stored without encryption, the app opens without asking for a passphrase, your recovery code stops working, and backups you make afterward are not encrypted. Choose **Continue** to go on or **Cancel** to keep the passphrase. If you continue, enter your current passphrase once to finish. You can turn it on again at any time.

Recovery code

When you turn a passphrase on or change it, the app shows a **recovery code** once. It looks like **ABCDE-FGHJK-LMNPQ-RSTUV-WXYZ2**. Write it down or save it somewhere safe, away from your phone, and keep it private; anyone who has it can open your data.

- If you forget your passphrase, type the recovery code in its place on the unlock screen. After you are in, open **Settings** → **Passphrase** and choose a new passphrase; you can enter the recovery code as the current passphrase. You will get a new recovery code.
- The recovery code is stored, locked, inside your backup files, so it also works when you restore a backup on a new phone.
- Changing your passphrase makes a new code, and the old one stops working. If you lose the code but still know your passphrase, open **Settings** → **Passphrase** → **Recovery Code** and choose **Make a New Recovery Code**.
- If you already had a passphrase before this feature, use that same button once to make your first code.

Add and organize contacts

- Choose the blue **+** button at the top of the contact list, enter a first name, and add any other details you have. A first name is required; other contact details can be completed later.
- Email and phone are optional. Enter an email such as **name@someemail**. Phone numbers are formatted as **(555) 123-4567**; enter a 10-digit U.S. number, or include a leading 1 for a U.S. country code.

- A contact can have one City, one Region within that City, and one Area within that Region. Region becomes available after choosing a City; Area becomes available after choosing a Region. These location details are optional. The Area list includes **+ Add New Area...** even when other areas are available, so you can create an area for the selected City and Region without leaving the contact form. The Region list likewise includes **+ Add New Region...** for the selected City. A Region is a large part of a city, and an Area is a neighborhood within a Region. Every new City is automatically given the Regions North, South, East, and West, which you can rename or delete in Settings.
- In **Settings**, use Edit beside a City, Region, or Area to rename it; existing contact assignments and child locations are updated. Delete is blocked while any contact is assigned to the location or to one beneath it; reassign those contacts first. Deleting a City or Region that has no assigned contacts also deletes the Regions and Areas under it, after you confirm.
- Different contacts may have the same name. The app assigns each contact a permanent ID to tell them apart.
- Choose **Save** (the disk icon at the bottom of the editor) to keep your changes. The **+** icon next to the title starts another new contact without leaving the editor, and the arrow icon in the bottom bar opens Google Maps directions. To edit an existing contact, use the pencil/edit action on its contact card.
- If you choose the **×** or close the editor after making changes, the app asks whether to leave without saving. Confirming discards those changes; canceling keeps the editor open.
- Use the round blue **Map** pin in the bottom navigation to view contacts that match the current search and filters and have map coordinates. Changing the search or filters also updates the map. Contacts without coordinates do not have a pin on the map. If no visible contacts have coordinates, the map centers approximately on the Default City and State saved in Settings. While the Map is open without pins, that city and state are sent to OpenStreetMap Nominatim for the lookup.
- In Settings, **Your Details** stores your name, address and home pin. Your home shows on the Map as a purple house icon (drag it to adjust), the Map opens fitted to include it, and your name is added to contacts you share. The address lookup button sends your address to OpenStreetMap Nominatim only when you choose it. Your details stay on this device and are included in backups.

In the contact form, choose **Find Address or City Pin** to look up a location using OpenStreetMap Nominatim. Choose **Use Device Location** instead to request the phone's current location. GPS uses the device's location, not the contact's address, and its accuracy can vary. The form shows the GPS-reported accuracy when available. Typing or saving an address does not run a lookup or create a pin automatically. Street addresses and newly entered location names are capitalized when you leave the field or save. Recognized U.S. state names are saved as standard two-letter abbreviations, and state codes are uppercased. Once a pin is set, choose **Confirm pin is correct** and the lookup buttons,

coordinates, and map are hidden, leaving a short "Map pin set" line. They return when you choose **Adjust pin** or change the street address, city, or state.

- If a partial street address has multiple possible matches, choose the correct street from the street-name list; choices omit house numbers and ZIP codes. Selecting a match fills in the street name using abbreviations such as Av and Ct, and places a pin. Contact addresses use abbreviated street suffixes throughout the app, including contacts saved earlier (for example, Avenue as Av and Road as Rd). If the full address is not found, the app also searches by the street name without its leading house number. You can choose a city without entering a street to place an approximate city pin. If you need a more precise result, enter a nearby cross-street or intersection and search again. These searches send the entered location text to OpenStreetMap Nominatim only after you choose the lookup button.
- Contacts saved without coordinates have no map pin. The Map page reports when matching contacts need coordinates; reopen one and use Find Address or City Pin to add them.
- The Map page opens zoomed to show every pin it will display. It shows the same contacts as the contact list, so the search and filters at the top apply to the map too; change them and the pins update.
- Both methods place a pin that you can refine. Tap another point on the contact form map, drag the pin, or edit the latitude and longitude fields. You can do this while adding or editing a contact. You can also drag an existing contact's pin on the Map page; its new coordinates save automatically.
- Check that the pin is in the right place before choosing **Save** (the disk icon at the bottom of the screen). Address lookup may not identify the exact entrance or building; device location may also need manual adjustment.

Map tiles also need an internet connection. Coordinates are optional, so you can save a contact without a pin and add coordinates later.

Find contacts and record visits

- Use the search box to search names, email addresses, phone numbers, addresses, or visit notes.
- Narrow the list with urgency, City, Region, or Area filters. Sort by newest, oldest, or name. Clear filters to see the full contact list again.
- Choose 🧭 **Navigate** on a contact card to open Google Maps directions. The app uses saved coordinates when available; otherwise it uses the contact's address. The destination is sent to Google Maps, and you can use the navigation options available on your device.

- Open a contact with the pencil button, then choose **Share** at the bottom of the Edit Contact screen, then choose **Text / SMS**, **WhatsApp**, or **Email**. The selected app opens with a plain-text summary containing the contact's name and any available phone, email, address, and directions link. Before choosing the service, you can also include no notes (the default), only the most recent note, or all notes; the dialog shows how many notes the contact has. This is plain text, not an encrypted contact export. Review the message before sending; your chosen messaging or email service receives the details. For app-to-app transfer, use the contact's export action instead.
- Add a visit quickly: tap the **ADD VISIT** button on a contact card. The contact opens on its **Visits** section with the cursor in the new-visit note box; the contact's details are one tap away under **Contact Info**. Type a note, or change the date and time, then use the green save icon. If you leave without typing a note or changing the date, no visit is added. Tapping the pencil instead opens **Contact Info**, and the visit history stays hidden until you tap **Visits**.
- Add a visit note while editing a contact: open the contact with the pencil button, type the note, and choose Save. You can adjust the note's date and time there, and existing notes can be edited or deleted from the same screen. Contact cards on the Contacts page show the last visit date, the number of notes, and the newest note's text. A search that matches only a visit note shows "Matches a visit note" on the card.
- To dictate a note instead of typing, tap the microphone key on your phone's or tablet's keyboard while the note field is selected. On iPhone and iPad it is at the bottom of the keyboard (turn it on in Settings → General → Keyboard → Enable Dictation if you don't see it). Android keyboards have a similar microphone key. The app does not record audio itself; dictation is handled by your device, which may send speech to Apple or Google depending on your device settings.
- Urgency is based on the most recent visit (or the contact's creation date if there are no visit notes): Normal is 0-7 days, Urgent is 8-14 days, and Immediate is 15 or more days.

Print contacts

- Every print button is the printer icon in the bar at the bottom of the screen, and it prints what is on that page. On the contact list it prints the contacts currently shown; search terms and filters determine what is included. The icon shows how many contacts will print, and the app confirms before printing.
- On the **Map** page, the printer icon asks whether to print just the numbered pins and addresses, or the pins with contact details. The numbers match the numbers on the map pins. Contacts without a pin are listed separately at the end.
- On the **Settings** page, the printer icon prints your settings: default state and city, whether a passphrase is on (never the passphrase itself), and your cities, regions, and areas.

- A list print includes each contact once, grouped under its most specific location: Area, or Region if there is no Area, or City if there is no Region or Area. Contacts without any of these are grouped under "No location assigned." Each contact's list entry includes its available phone and email details and only its latest note.
- To print one contact, open that saved contact and choose the printer icon at the bottom. Choose the most recent note only (the default) or all notes.
- Save contact edits before printing. If the printer icon is unavailable while editing, save your changes first. Printing opens your device or browser's print options; saving as a PDF may be available there.

Protect your information and make a backup

Your contacts and settings are stored in this device's browser, and are encrypted if you have turned on a passphrase. They are not uploaded to an account and are not automatically backed up unless you turn on the optional cloud backup. Clearing browser data, losing the device, or forgetting the passphrase (if one is on) can make the local records unavailable. Make backups regularly and keep them somewhere safe.

- On the contact list, choose the export icon (a tray with an arrow pointing up) at the bottom. With no search or filter active, this downloads a full backup of all contacts and settings. With a search or filter active, it exports only the contacts shown, as a contacts file. With no passphrase it downloads immediately. If a passphrase is on, a box asks whether to encrypt the file; it is ticked by default, and unticking it shows a warning that anyone with the file can read it. Your browser saves it to its usual Downloads location.
- You can also choose **Settings** → **Backup & Restore** → **Back up everything** to download a full backup at any time. The top of that section also shows whether your browser has agreed to protect the app's storage from being cleared; backups are still recommended either way.
- To move your full collection to a new device, open the app there and choose **Choose Backup to Restore** on the first screen. Select the backup and, if it is encrypted, enter the passphrase used when it was created.
- Restoring a full backup replaces the contacts and settings currently on that device. Check the confirmation carefully before continuing.
- **One passphrase and one recovery code for all your devices.** Restoring an encrypted backup onto a device that has no passphrase turns the passphrase on there (after a message and your confirmation), using the backup's passphrase and recovery code. Restoring an encrypted backup onto a device with a different passphrase switches that device to the backup's passphrase and

recovery code. Restoring an unencrypted backup onto a device that has a passphrase keeps that device's own passphrase and protects the restored data with it. After you change your passphrase on one device, the others keep the old one until they restore a newer backup, which needs the new passphrase or new recovery code.

- To share one contact, open it with the pencil button and use the export icon at the bottom of the Edit Contact screen. This creates a contact file. If your device has a passphrase, the file is encrypted and you give the recipient its separate sharing passphrase through a different channel; with no passphrase, the file is plain and needs none, so send it only to someone you trust.
- To import one or more contacts, choose the import icon (a tray with an arrow pointing down) next to the blue **+** at the top of the contact list and select one or several contact files. You are asked for a passphrase only if a file is encrypted. Importing adds the contacts without replacing any existing ones.

Cloud backup and sync (optional)

Cloud backup keeps a copy of your contacts and settings in your own Dropbox account, outside your phone. If your phone is lost, broken or replaced, you can restore from Dropbox instead of needing a file you saved earlier. If you connect more than one device to the same Dropbox, it also keeps them in step (see Syncing between devices). It is off unless you turn it on. Dropbox is entirely optional: the app works fully without it, nothing is sent anywhere, and all your data can stay only on this device. The file backups described above keep working either way.

> **You need a Dropbox account.** The app can send you to Dropbox to sign up, but it cannot create the account for you. The free Basic plan is enough. Dropbox may offer a paid trial; you can skip it.

Turn it on

1. Open **Settings** → **Cloud backup (optional)** and choose **Set Up Cloud Backup**.
2. Choose **Yes, I have one** if you already have a Dropbox account. If not, choose **No, help me get one** and follow the steps: open dropbox.com/basic, sign up, choose the free **Basic** plan, confirm your email if asked, then come back to the app and choose **I Have My Account, Continue**.
3. Choose **Connect to Dropbox**. Sign in to Dropbox when it asks and tap **Allow**. The app can only use its own folder, **Return Visits**, and cannot see anything else in your Dropbox. Dropbox then sends you back to the app.

4. The app makes your first backup and shows when it finished. If you connect on a new device with no contacts and Dropbox already has a backup, the app offers to restore it.

How it works

- The app checks Dropbox when you open it, and backs up about 15 seconds after you make changes or as you leave the app. While it is open it also checks every couple of minutes. A web app cannot back up while it is closed, so this happens when you use it.
- Dropbox keeps a **latest copy** plus up to 10 dated copies (at most one new dated copy per day). Older dated copies are removed automatically.
- **Encryption:** if a passphrase is on, backups sent to Dropbox are encrypted with it. Without a passphrase the backups in your Dropbox are not encrypted, so the app asks you to confirm before connecting. Your Dropbox sign-in is separate from your app passphrase. Dropbox copies saved before you turned a passphrase on stay unencrypted until they age out, so consider turning the passphrase on before you connect.
- To restore, choose **Settings** → **Cloud backup** → **Restore from Dropbox**, pick the latest copy or a dated one, and confirm. Restoring replaces the contacts and settings on this device. If the backup is encrypted, you enter its passphrase or recovery code.
- **Back Up to Dropbox Now** makes a backup immediately. **Disconnect Dropbox** stops backing up; your existing copies stay in your Dropbox. To remove the app's access completely, you can also remove Return Visits in your Dropbox account's connected apps.
- The app never replaces your Dropbox copy with an empty one: it does not back up automatically when this device has no contacts.
- Using more than one device is covered next, under Syncing between devices.

Syncing between devices

Syncing is part of Dropbox backup. **If you do not connect Dropbox, nothing syncs**: your contacts stay only on that device, and each device is separate. If you connect every device to the same Dropbox, they combine their changes automatically.

> **All devices that sync together must use the same passphrase and the same recovery code.** Dropbox and your device sign-in are the only protection the app requires. A passphrase is only needed if you want your Dropbox copies encrypted; turn it on once, on your main device.

Setting up a second device (for example an iPad)

1. On your main device (the one that has your contacts), make a file backup first. If you want encrypted Dropbox copies, turn on the passphrase now under **Settings** → **Passphrase** and save the recovery code. Then connect Dropbox as described above and wait for the cloud icon to show it is synced.
2. On the second device, install or update the app, open **Settings** → **Cloud backup (optional)** and connect to the **same Dropbox account**. Do not turn on a passphrase there first.
3. When the app says Dropbox already has a backup, choose **Restore**, not Replace. Pick the latest copy. If it is encrypted, enter the passphrase or recovery code from your main device; the second device then uses that same passphrase and recovery code.
4. Your contacts appear and the cloud icon shows it is synced. After this the two devices stay in step by themselves.

Day to day

- Each device combines with Dropbox when you open the app, about every couple of minutes while it is open, and as soon as a lost connection returns. After you make a change, wait about 15 seconds before switching to the other device.
- Contacts and visits added on different devices are all kept. Deleting a contact or a visit on one device removes it on the others.
- If two devices change the very same contact at nearly the same time, the most recent change to that contact's details is used, but visits from both devices are kept.
- With no signal, your changes stay saved on the device and upload automatically when it can reach Dropbox again.
- The cloud icon at the top right shows the state: ☁️ up to date, 🔄 syncing, ⏳ changes waiting to upload, 📴 no connection (your changes are kept), ⚠️ paused and needs attention. Tap it to sync now and read the message. **Check for a Newer Backup** does the same from Settings.
- If a device uses a different passphrase than the Dropbox copy, the app cannot combine them. It asks whether to restore the Dropbox copy and keeps automatic backup paused until you decide. Use **Back Up to Dropbox Now** only if you want this device's data to replace the Dropbox copy; older dated copies stay.
- Connecting a device that already has contacts to a Dropbox that already has a backup asks whether to restore (replace this device) or replace the Dropbox copy. Choose carefully.
- Limits: a city, region or area you delete on one device can come back from another, and renaming one can leave the old name behind. Settings other than those lists come from the device that changed them last.

Backup reminder

If 10 days or more pass without a successful backup (file or Dropbox), the app asks "You haven't backed up in N days. Back up now?". It asks at most once a day. With Dropbox connected, choosing Yes backs up immediately; otherwise it opens **Settings** → **Backup & Restore**. Only a successful backup resets the count.

Consolidate copies and remove unused data

If Safari, Chrome, and a Home Screen app each have contacts, they are separate local copies and do not sync, even if you use Dropbox on one of them. For regular phone use, choose the Home Screen app as the one copy to keep. A full backup restore replaces all contacts and settings in the destination; it does not merge two full backups.

1. Decide which copy will be your permanent one. If it already contains contacts you want to keep, leave it as the destination and import other contacts into it individually. If you choose a different base copy, remember that restoring its full backup will replace the destination's current contacts and settings.
2. Before changing anything, export an encrypted full backup from every copy that contains information you may need. Keep these backups until the consolidation is complete.
3. Use the full backup from your chosen base copy to populate the destination, if needed. From every other copy, export contacts one at a time with the export icon in Edit Contact, or all at once by exporting the contact list with the export icon at the bottom of the contact list while a filter is active. Then import the files into the destination with the import icon at the top of the contact list. Imports add records; they do not replace the collection.
4. Review the destination for missing or duplicate contacts and confirm important visit notes are present. Contact imports may create a duplicate if the same person is already in the destination.
5. Export a new encrypted full backup from the destination. Keep it somewhere safe and confirm you know its passphrase before deleting any source copy.
6. Only after verification, remove the unused copies using the removal instructions below. Clear data only for a source copy you no longer need. If the browser's controls do not make it clear which copy will be removed, do not clear it until you have confirmed the surviving copy still opens with all your contacts.

> Full backups cannot be merged directly. If you need to bring over contacts from a second full backup, restore that backup only if you are ready to replace the destination, or import its contacts

> individually. Do not delete source data or backup files until the destination has been checked and backed up.

Stop using the app and remove its saved data

Remove unused app data

> Uninstalling the Home Screen app alone may not remove its browser-stored data. To remove the app's local contacts and settings, clear the site data for **grasfulls.github.io** in the browser that you used. This permanently deletes that browser copy. If you want to keep your contacts, export an encrypted backup first.

- **iPhone or iPad:** To remove the Safari browser copy, open iOS **Settings** → **Safari** → **Advanced** → **Website Data**, find **grasfulls.github.io**, and delete its website data. To remove a separate Home Screen app copy, touch and hold its icon, choose **Remove App**, then **Delete App**. Menu names may vary slightly by iOS version.
- **Android (Chrome):** Open Chrome's settings for **grasfulls.github.io** and choose **Clear data** or **Clear & reset**. You can also find it under **Settings** → **Site settings** → **All sites**.
- **Other browsers or computers:** Use the browser's website data or site storage settings to remove data for **grasfulls.github.io**.
- Repeat this in each browser and on each device where you used the app; each copy may have separate data. Uninstall the Home Screen app separately if you also want to remove its icon.
- This does not delete downloaded backups, exported contact files, PDFs, or printed copies. Remove those separately from Downloads, Files, cloud storage, or wherever you saved or shared them.

Use the app on another device

On another device, open the Return Visits app in a web browser. Your contacts will not appear automatically; restore an encrypted backup using the instructions above. For regular use on a phone, we recommend adding the app to your Home Screen: in Safari on iPhone, use Share then Add to Home Screen; in Chrome on Android, choose Install app or Add to Home screen. The app checks for updates when it opens and prompts you once it has opened if an update is ready; an exclamation mark also appears by Settings. To check or refresh manually, open **Settings** → **App updates** → **Check for**

Updates & Refresh while online. If there is no update, a "No update available" message appears; tap OK to close it. Save or finish any open contact or Settings edits first; if something is unsaved, the app names the exact section and field and takes you to it. Also, if you leave Settings with unsaved edits, the app asks "Discard unsaved changes?" Choose OK to discard them, or Cancel to stay and finish. The app reloads its code without removing the contacts and settings stored in that app copy. After it reloads, unlock using the same passphrase if you have turned one on.

Already using the app in your phone's browser?

The browser version and the Home Screen app do not automatically sync their contacts. Adding the app to your Home Screen does not transfer the data already saved in your browser; the two versions may keep separate local copies. To move your contacts, first confirm they are visible in the browser version, then choose **Settings → Backup & Restore → Back up everything**. Open the Home Screen app and choose **Choose Backup to Restore** on its unlock screen, or use its restore option in Settings. Keep using the browser copy until you have confirmed the contacts are visible in the Home Screen app. After the transfer, changes made in one copy will not appear in the other; export and restore a fresh backup when you want to move newer changes.

> The app is free to use, but it does not include an online sync service. If you use more than one copy, keep track of which one has your latest changes. You must manually export and restore encrypted backups to transfer changes; restoring a full backup replaces the destination copy's contacts and settings.

Return to the Return Visits app